

Lab 2.3: Develop a SPIN Questioning Script

Introduction

In this lab, you will practice structured discovery using the SPIN framework.

Your goal is to demonstrate how SPIN supports a natural conversation that confirms context, surfaces meaningful problems, explores business impact, and frames value, all before proposing a solution.

This is not a pitch script. It is a questioning framework that helps you understand the prospect's reality before positioning your offering. Strong discovery conversations don't feel scripted; they feel intentional.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lab, you will be able to:

- Apply the SPIN framework to create a logical question progression
- Identify Situation questions that confirm context without interrogating
- Explain Problem questions that surface friction without leading
- Describe Implication questions that reveal business impact and urgency
- Recognize Need-Payoff questions that help prospects articulate value themselves



Scenario

Company Name: ProClean Commercial Services

Industry: Commercial office cleaning and janitorial services

Prospect: Riverside Legal Partners (mid-sized law firm with 85 attorneys and staff)

Current Situation:

- Uses in-house cleaning staff (3 full-time employees)
- Leadership has noticed inconsistent cleaning quality in recent months
- Employee complaints about conference rooms and common areas
- Office Manager spends increasing time managing facilities issues
- Not actively shopping for vendors but open to improving operational reliability

Your Role

You are a sales representative from ProClean conducting an exploratory discovery call with the Office Manager. You have done basic research and confirmed they have an in-house team, but you do not know the details of their current challenges.

Tools/Downloadable Resources

Downloadable Resource: SPIN Question Bank Template

Activity Steps

Exercise 1: Draft Your SPIN Questioning Script

Step 1: Review the SPIN Framework

Before writing your script, review what each SPIN stage accomplishes:

Situation (S): Confirm current state and validate research assumptions

Problem (P): Surface inefficiencies, frustrations, or constraints

Implication (I): Explore consequences, including financial, operational, or strategic

Need-Payoff (N): Help prospect define success and articulate value

Step 2: Draft Situation Questions

Write at least two questions that:

- Confirm what you already know from research
- Establish baseline understanding without interrogating
- Sound natural and conversational
- Avoid questions you could have answered with LinkedIn or website research

Step 3: Draft Problem Questions

Write at least two questions that:

- Surface friction points or operational challenges
- Allow the prospect to describe pain in their own words
- Focus on "where" and "what" rather than "why"
- Avoid leading language or solution assumptions

Step 4: Draft Implication Questions

Write at least two questions that:

- Explore consequences of the problems identified
- Reveal business impact (such as time, cost, or employee experience)
- Create urgency by connecting problems to outcomes
- Go at least two layers deep. For example: "What impact does that have?"

Step 5: Draft Need-Payoff Questions

Write at least two questions that:

- Help the prospect articulate value of solving the problem
- Focus on outcomes and benefits, not features
- Let the prospect define what success would look like
- Provide insights before you propose any solution

Step 6: Review for Flow and Tone

Read through your complete script and check if:

- Questions flow logically from one stage to the next
- Tone is consultative and professional throughout
- Solution-biased or leading language is used
- Questions mistakenly sound like statements

Success Criteria

A strong submission will:

- Include at least two questions for each SPIN stage (8+ total)
- Demonstrate clear progression from context → friction → impact → value
- Use neutral and non-assumptive language. For example, "Don't you think..." or "Wouldn't you agree..." should not be ideally used
- Show natural conversation flow, not interrogation
- Avoid jumping to solutions or pitching features



Reflect a professional and consultative tone appropriate for a law firm Office Manager

Connect each question to insights from the previous answer, even if implied

Self-Assessment Checklist

By the end of this lab, you should have:

- A SPIN questioning script with clearly labeled sections (S-P-I-N)

- At least 2 questions for each SPIN stage (8+ questions total)

- Questions that flow logically from context to impact to value

- Questions in a neutral and professional language appropriate for the scenario

- Evidence of understanding SPIN principles, not just memorization

Summary

Congratulations! You have completed your first SPIN questioning script. This lab reinforces that strong discovery conversations are not about clever questions; they are about intentional sequencing, active listening, and helping prospects surface their own insights.

Remember that the goal of discovery is understanding and alignment, not interrogation. Use SPIN as a thinking framework, not a script.
